

# Refrigerator

From hauling chunks of ice down mountains to opening a refrigerator door, chilling out has become a lot easier.

The COOLEST invention of them all

In early refrigerators, the compressor unit was located on top. Now, it is hidden inside.



## The big freeze

Before refrigerators, people kept food from spoiling by storing it in **cool, dark places** or in a **hole packed with ice or snow** brought from the nearest mountain or frozen lake. Later on, rich families had specially built **ICEHOUSES**, with ice often imported in blocks from **overseas**. The trade in ice continued into the 1950s—this iceman is supplying ice to businesses from his truck.

## First fridges

In 1748, Scottish physician **William Cullen** discovered that evaporating ether could create freezing temperatures because evaporating liquids absorb heat. The first chilling machine, invented by American engineer **Jacob Perkins** in 1834, used this principle. Soon, **INDUSTRIAL REFRIGERATORS** were cooling beer and meat. Domestic models became available in the 20th century.

### Did you know?

In 1841, American doctor John Gorrie invented a refrigerator to cool feverish patients. It was the forerunner of air-conditioning.

It paved the way for...



Cooling units for **REFRIGERATED TRUCKS** were introduced in the 1930s, making perishable goods much **EASIER TO TRANSPORT**.



First introduced into stores in the 1870s, **REFRIGERATED DISPLAY CASES** kept food **FRESH LONGER**.



Several shelves stored food, and there was a small compartment for ice.